Stop, Think, Choose!

Lyrics (1)



Wait!

Before I do it...
Before I say it...

I can stop!

Take a breath...

Think...

And choose!

Max was building with his blocks,
Higher, higher, to the top!

Buddy came running through the room...

BUMP!

Down went the tower —
BOOM, BOOM, BOOM!

Max felt angry right away,
He almost shouted,
"GO AWAY!"

But then he stopped.

One little breath...

"What could I do instead?"

I can stop
before I act.

I can think:
"What happens next?"

I've got choices
I can use.

Stop...
Think...
Then I choose!

STOP!
THINK!
CHOOSE!

I've got choices
I can use!

STOP!
THINK!
CHOOSE!

I can choose
what I will do!

Stop, Think, Choose!

Lyrics (2)

Take a breath!
Think it through!

What's a good choice
I can choose?

My feelings can be big...

But I decide
what I will do!

STOP!
THINK!
CHOOSE!

Mia saw some cookies
on a plate.

"Ooh! I want one!
They look great!"

She reached her hand...

then stopped to think:

"Did someone say
that I could take one?"

She pulled her hand back,
then went to ask:

"Can I have a cookie, please?"

"After lunch,"
Grandma Nell replied.

"Okay!"

Mia smiled
and stepped aside.

She wanted one,
but she could wait.

She made a choice
that felt just great!

I can stop
before I act.

I can think:
"What happens next?"

I've got choices
I can use.

Stop...
Think...
Then I choose!

STOP!
THINK!
CHOOSE!

I've got choices
I can use!

STOP!
THINK!
CHOOSE!

I can choose
what I will do!

Take a breath!
Think it through!

What's a good choice
I can choose?

My feelings can be big...

Stop, Think, Choose!

Lyrics (3)

But I decide
what I will do!

STOP!
THINK!
CHOOSE!

Jay was waiting for the slide,
Another child stepped in the line.

Jay wanted to push ahead:

"Hey!
I was waiting!"

But instead...

He stopped,
took one slow breath,
and thought about
what he could say next.

"Excuse me,
I was waiting here."

The other child said,
"Oh! Sorry!"

And moved behind.

No pushing.
No shouting.

Just words
that worked out fine!

Want to grab it?

STOP!

Want to shout?

BREATHE!

What comes next?

THINK!

Do I have choices?

YES, I DO!

Can I use my words?

YES, I CAN!

Can I walk away?

YES, I CAN!

Can I ask for help?

YES, I CAN!

So what do I do?

STOP!
THINK!
CHOOSE!

Self-control doesn't mean
I never feel excited.

It doesn't mean
I never feel angry.

It means...

I don't have to do
the very first thing
my feelings tell me to do.

I can pause.

I can think.

Stop, Think, Choose!

Lyrics (4)

And I can choose.

STOP!
THINK!
CHOOSE!

I've got choices
I can use!

STOP!
THINK!
CHOOSE!

I can choose
what I will do!

Take a breath!
Think it through!

Find a choice
that's good for you!

I can wait!
I can speak!
I can ask!
I can leave!

I can choose
what happens next!

STOP!

THINK!

CHOOSE!

My feelings belong to me...

And I can choose
what I will do!

Before I act...

I can pause.

Before I shout...

I can breathe.

Before I choose...

I can think.

STOP...

THINK...

CHOOSE!